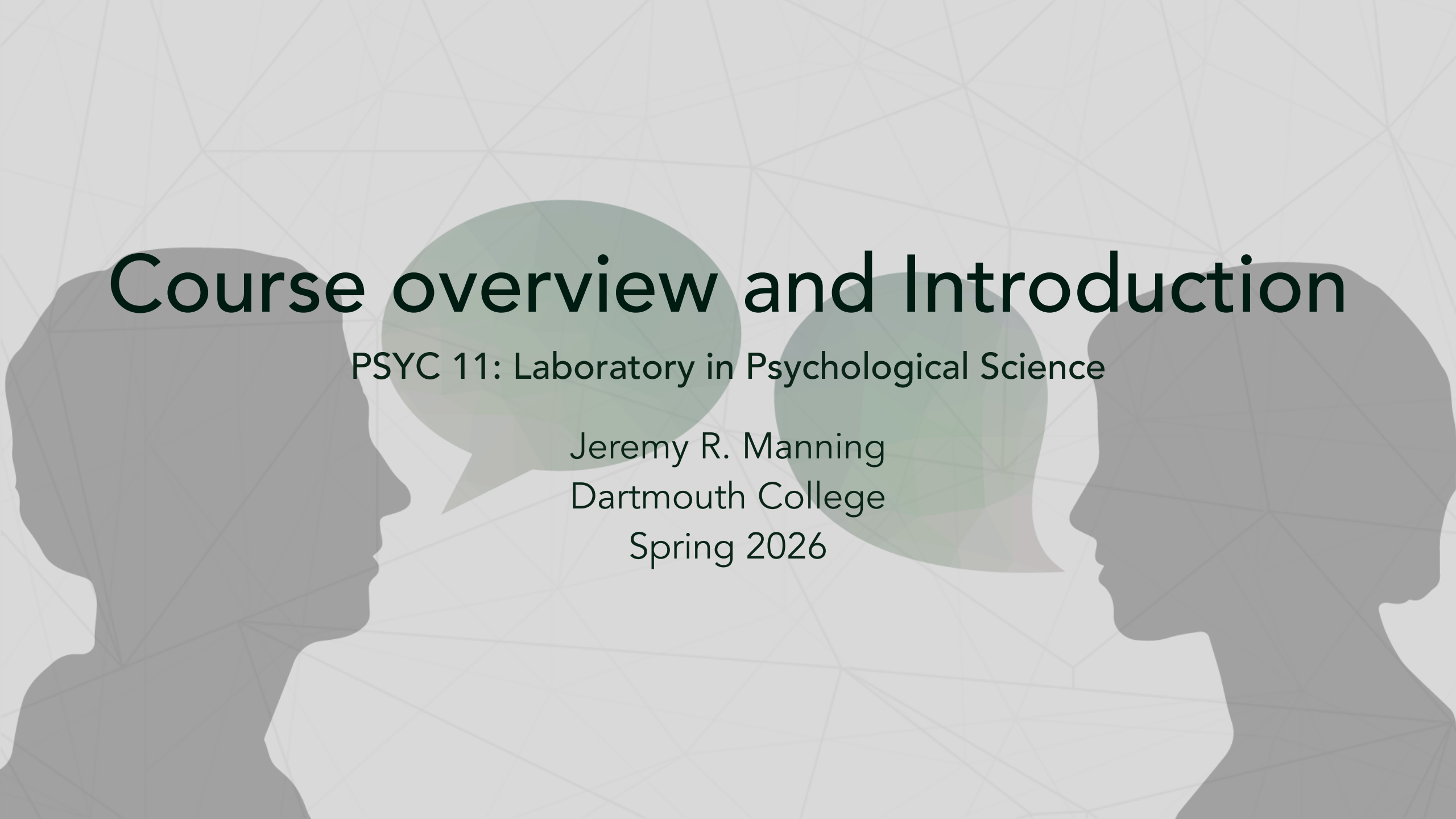




Course overview and Introduction

PSYC 11: Laboratory in Psychological Science

Jeremy R. Manning
Dartmouth College
Spring 2026

What is this course about?

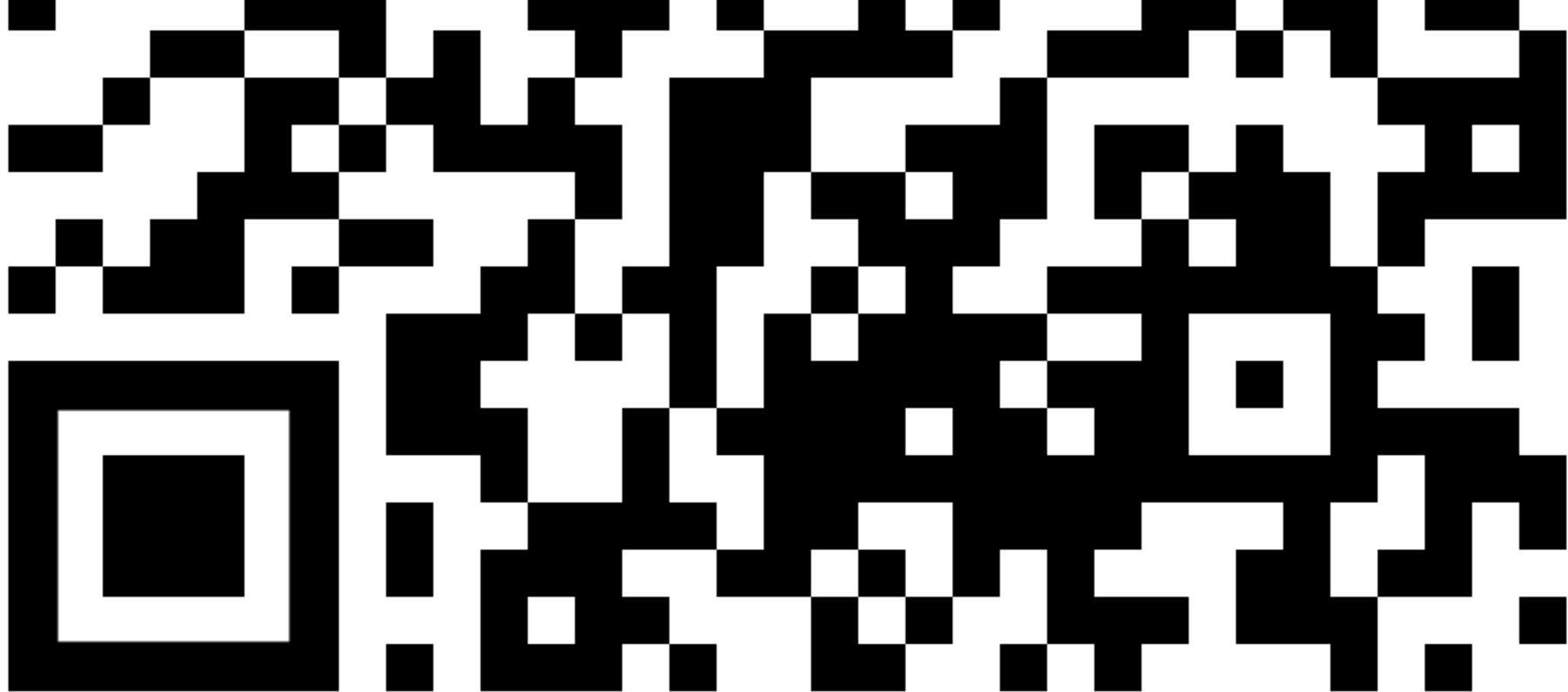
- Learn how to carry out psychological research
- Doing research vs. writing a (complete) scientific article:
 - Introduction: motivate your research question
 - Methods: describe how you studied the question
 - Results: describe what you found
 - Discussion: situation your findings in the broader literature

Why should you care about writing?

- Formulate your question and approach
- Share what you did and found
- Learn to read and critically evaluate other work

Organization

- First 5(ish) weeks: in-class labs, each focused on teaching you about one section of scientific articles
- Last 5(ish) weeks: carry out your own research study
- Goal: leave this course with a deep understanding of how psychological research is "done"



Logistics

- I'll hold **office hours** by appointment on Mondays and Thursdays. Schedule through: context-lab.youcanbook.me (or email me).
- If you post questions on Slack, I'll answer them (usually within 1-2 business days).
- If you have any comments, questions, concerns, etc., **please let me know** (via Slack DMs or email: jeremy@dartmouth.edu).

Teaching assistants

- Sarah Kerns
- Yeongji Lee
- Zizhuang Miao



Contextual Dynamics Lab

- Build brain models to understand how our brain structures interact during learning and memory
- Computational models, data science tools
- More info: www.context-lab.com



Birthday lab!

- Gentle introduction to asking questions in a scientific way (aside: how is this different from a "regular" question?)
- Does anyone **know** they have a birthday twin in the room?
- How many people would you **expect** to have matching birthdays?
- What makes a "good" hypothesis vs. a "bad" hypothesis?

